12TH EDITION Submissions open for AIFF 2027

YOUR STORY DESERVES THE SCREEN

CALL FOR ENTRIES

INDIAN COMPETITION (FEATURE FILM)

EXTENDED DEADLINE
30TH SEPTEMBER 2026

SUBMIT YOUR FILM →

Read the regulations

12TH AIFF · SUBMISSIONS

Two ways to enter

Send us your feature for the Indian Competition, or your short film if you are a filmmaker from the Marathwada region.

FEATURE FILM

Deadline 30 Sep 2026

Indian Competition

Best Film wins the Golden Kailash with a cash prize of ₹3,00,000. Also competing for Best Actor, Actress, Script, FIPRESCI and Audience Choice.

ENTRY FORM Regulations

SHORT FILM · REGIONAL

Deadline [DATE]

Marathwada Short Film Competition

For filmmakers from the Marathwada region. The best short film selected by the jury receives a trophy and a cash prize of ₹25,000.

ENTRY FORM Rules & regulations

ABOUT AIFF

World cinema, in the city of Ajanta & Ellora

The festival brings the best of recent and classic cinema from India and around the world to Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar and its film lovers. It is a platform for aspiring filmmakers, technicians, artists and young enthusiasts to learn the art and craft of cinema — and to put Marathwada on the map as a hub for film production and culture.

More about the festival →

Film Appreciation Workshops

Learn to read films with critics and practitioners.

Special Screenings

Country focus, restored classics and tributes.

Seminars & Panels

Conversations on the changing face of cinema.

Masterclasses

Sessions with leading directors and artists.

AIFF AWARDS

The Kailash awards

Past winners →

BEST FILM

Golden Kailash

+ Cash prize of ₹3,00,000

Best Actor

Silver Kailash with a cash prize of ₹25,000.

Best Actress

Silver Kailash with a cash prize of ₹25,000.

Best Script

Silver Kailash with a cash prize of ₹25,000.

Best Short Film

Trophy and ₹25,000 for the best short from Marathwada.

FIPRESCI Award

By FIPRESCI-India, for a director's first or second film.

Audience Choice

Chosen by the festival's discerning audience.

HONOURING A LIFETIME

Padmapani Lifetime Achievement Award

I	SP	JA	AK	SB	GK	AP
Ilaiyaraaja	**Sai Paranjpye**	**Javed Akhtar**	**Arun Khopkar**	**Sumitra Bhave**	**Girish Kasaravalli**	**Amol Palekar**
2026	2025	2024	2023	2020	2019	2018

Portrait placeholders — replace with recipient photographs.

FROM THE ARCHIVE · 11TH AIFF

Festival highlights

Browse the archive →

Poster ·Sirāt

OPENING FILM

Sirāt

Dir. Óliver Laxe · Spain, France · 2025 · 120′

Poster ·Sabar Bonda

MID-FEST FILM

Sabar Bonda

Dir. Rohan Kanawade · India, UK, Canada · 2025 · 112′

Poster ·It Was Just an Accident

CLOSING FILM

It Was Just an Accident

Dir. Jafar Panahi · France, Iran · 2025 · 105′

Festival leadership

Meet the full team →

NK	**Nandkishor Kagliwal**	Chairman
AG	**Ashutosh Gowariker**	Honorary Chairman
AK	**Ankushrao Kadam**	Chief Mentor
SS	**Sunil Sukthankar**	Festival Director

ORGANISED BY	Nath Group	MGM	Yashwantrao Chavan Center	MACFF
SUPPORTED BY	Ministry of Information & Broadcasting	[Partner logo]	[Partner logo]	[Partner logo]

AIFF

Ajanta-Ellora International Film Festival
12th edition · 20–24 January 2027
Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar, Maharashtra

STAY IN THE LOOP

Festival updates in your inbox

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